
Magistrate Wizard — Court Assignment

Plain-language workflow. See the collected pack for the full set.

Magistrate Wizard

Architecture as implemented (migrations 0001–0067)

Court-anchored Docket · no admin bypass into private judicial content

13 August 2026

2. Court assignment

Who: administrator seats; magistrate is seated

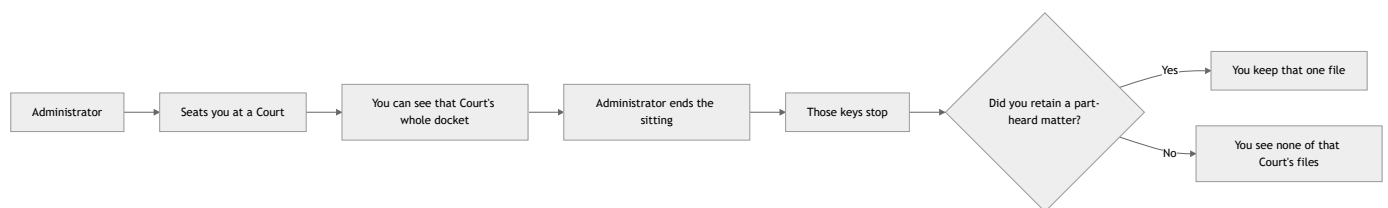
Goal: open the Court's docket for a person

Everyday analogy: handing someone the keys to a particular courtroom's filing cabinet

Why this exists

A docket is **not** "Magistrate X's cases". It is **that Court's cases**. The software therefore asks: *who is currently sitting this Court?*

That answer lives in a dated assignment. While the end date is empty, you have the keys. When an administrator fills the end date, those keys stop working.



What the administrator does

1. Open **Court Assignments** (admin menu).
2. Choose the magistrate's profile.
3. Choose an **active** Court.
4. Create the assignment.

To move someone to another Court: **end** the current assignment, then create a new one. Do not pretend the old row was always the new Court — history is kept.

To offboard someone: end their Court sittings (and make sure part-heard retains are ended too). Prefer **deactivating** the account later. Do not delete the person if they created docket files — the system needs to remember who did the work.

What the magistrate cannot do

You cannot seat yourself. You cannot end your own Court sitting. That is deliberate. Anyone who could seat themselves could open any Court's cabinet.

Assignment types

Regular, acting, relief, or other. They are labels for the roster. **They do not change permissions.** Any current sitting, of any type, opens that Court's docket the same way.

Dual access is normal

Suppose you retained matter 45 from a Court you left. A new magistrate is now seated there. **Both of you can open matter 45.** You are not the owner. You are finishing a hearing. They are running the Court.

Related guide

When you are about to leave, read [Sharing and retained matters](#) *before* the administrator ends your sitting. You can only retain a matter while you still have the Court keys.